A new governor Hunizah Meerza one of the King's uncles has been appointed governor general of Azerbijan. I thought of trying to get sent to Tabreez with him, but have now given up the idea, for many reasons one of which is that I do not think they would let me go, and I might vex the king and his minister by asking. Otherwise my four hundred tomauns a year there, would be good as six here, because that is such a cheap place, and then I should most likely get extra pay from the govr genl and allowances. But I have determined to try my luck here for some time to come at least.

I asked you some time ago whether Persian carpets would sell in America. Perhaps you never saw any. We have nothing in England so good and durable, but on account of their shape (paralelogram) they are not much used in Europe, except the small ones which are used as rugs these cost about from S30/ to 40/ at Tabreez.

How does your trade go on, where do you live? in the town of New York or near it? is it not from the quantity of steamers a place something like Liverpool?

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tehran, February 21, 1850*

How is the climate of New York during the summer, I suppose hot, and very cold in the winter. Are you much troubled with mosquitoes during the hot months as we are here. In fact on all the plains of Persia these unpleasant little animals abound, that is wherever the cultivation is carried on by turning a stream of water over the ground to irrigate it, as this forms an artificial marsh and produces mosquitoes fevers and agues and other disagreeables.

Has the gold from California made much difference in the trade of New York? The papers say not, at least as far as the money market is concerned. But by degrees the people collecting there must cause a brisk trade in manufactures.

Persia is still a good deal unsettled and Meshed the capital of Khorassan is yet in the hands of the rebels.[124] The government have sent an immense force against this city but as yet they have not been able to take it. Partly owing to its being considered a holy place and both soldiers and officers being unwilling to fight against it. Its sanctity however would not prevent the soldiers from plundering it if they could get into the town.

My friend Mr Abbott our consul here has gone on a journey to the south of Persia from whence he will return by way of Bushur, Busora, Baghdad to Kermanshah and here. The government pay his expenses and he is to make up a commercial report on the trade of the countries he passes through.

[124] Salar withstood a siege of eighteen months in Meshed, at the end of which period he was handed over to the besiegers by the townspeople. He was barbarously tortured in a vain attempt to make him reveal the hiding place of his treasure, and then strangled.

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